

Employer Negotiation Brief

Negotiation underpins almost every aspect of leadership — yet outside sales and procurement it is rarely trained at all.

Perhaps it gets a short section within a leadership programme, but mostly negotiation is treated as something occasional: a salary review, a supplier contract, a client renewal.

In practice, it determines not just who does what, but how good the answer is.

Who gets the resources. Whose deadline moves. Which project is properly scoped and which one quietly absorbs everything nobody else wanted. Whether a difficult conversation with a supplier, a client or another function ends in a workable answer or a stalemate that costs three weeks.

Senior people do this every day, mostly by instinct, and most have never been taught it.

WHAT THE ORGANISATION GETS

- **Better answers when priorities collide.** Rather than simply concede or dig in, reshape the problem — scope, sequence, resource, timing or trade-offs — with clients, suppliers and colleagues.
- **More deliberate use of resources.** Secure what a project actually needs, protect senior time for where it adds most value, and negotiate rather than silently absorb competing demands.
- **Difficult issues addressed earlier.** Raise problems with clients, suppliers, peers or teams while they're still relatively cheap to solve.
- **Agreements that hold.** Build workable outcomes that account for what both sides need, rather than deals that unravel in implementation.

It may also help you keep them. Workload that quietly creeps, a promotion that is never properly discussed, a role that stops fitting — unresolved issues become reasons to leave. Someone equipped to raise and negotiate those things has a better chance of resolving them before leaving becomes the easier option.

WHAT IT INVOLVES

Format	Live, virtual, delivered over 12 months
Time commitment	Eight 90-minute sessions in the first two months, then approximately one hour a month
When	Fridays, 12:30–14:00 UK
Cohort	A small group — no more than eight — of senior women from different organisations
Cost	£3,500, or ten monthly payments of £375
Invoicing	To the organisation, the individual, or both

Closing The Gap combines research-informed negotiation strategy with the opportunity to apply it to the real conversations and decisions participants are navigating at work.

Part-funding is straightforward — I can invoice the organisation for its contribution and the participant separately for the balance.

WHO DELIVERS IT

Lucy Watson spent 25+ years in financial services and technology, including at Barclays and Oliver Wyman, and as co-founder of an enterprise technology company. She has negotiated from many perspectives: employee, leader, co-founder, supplier and customer. INSEAD MBA.